

NEXUS-IR | Find Evil! SANS 2026

Session: 20260521_223143 Generated: 2026-05-21 22:31 UTC Duration: 2.08s Version: 4.0.0-langgraph

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Threat Level:	CRITICAL 100/100
Case Priority:	CRITICAL
Files Scanned:	6
Attack Patterns:	3
IPs Identified:	2
Findings Valid:	15
Findings Rejected:	0
Confidence:	HIGH
Auto-Remediated:	0 pattern(s) injected by devil advocate
LangGraph Iters:	1

CHAIN OF CUSTODY -- EVIDENCE INTEGRITY

File:	sysmon_execution.json
SHA256:	619304a909d0de9741ac108a2ac53e2d366788677f5f7b66c59bdd492bb6a786
Size:	914 bytes
Hashed at:	2026-05-21T22:31:44.09791
File:	sysmon_execution.log
SHA256:	619304a909d0de9741ac108a2ac53e2d366788677f5f7b66c59bdd492bb6a786
Size:	914 bytes
Hashed at:	2026-05-21T22:31:44.39113
File:	sysmon_injection.json
SHA256:	670fa5d537a5337b60c444b935c93dbcb1129f404bcd8fef7d95d15b19246d00
Size:	915 bytes
Hashed at:	2026-05-21T22:31:44.68771
File:	sysmon_injection.log
SHA256:	670fa5d537a5337b60c444b935c93dbcb1129f404bcd8fef7d95d15b19246d00
Size:	915 bytes
Hashed at:	2026-05-21T22:31:44.98342
File:	zeek_network.json
SHA256:	a1f2ebf54ab8ff4069e38a67cf5e34e1fcec121526753060a5dc2fbcee5fbea1
Size:	1188 bytes
Hashed at:	2026-05-21T22:31:45.28802
File:	zeek_network.log
SHA256:	a1f2ebf54ab8ff4069e38a67cf5e34e1fcec121526753060a5dc2fbcee5fbea1
Size:	1188 bytes
Hashed at:	2026-05-21T22:31:45.57640

ATTACK NARRATIVE -- KILL CHAIN SUMMARY

A heavily obfuscated PowerShell command was executed on A1B2C3D4-E5F6 (ProcessID 1128) using ExecutionPolicy Bypass and WindowStyle Hidden flags, indicating a fileless malware execution technique designed to evade endpoint detection. The malicious process injected shellcode into a legitimate system process (GrantedAccess=0x1FFFFF) -- this is PROCESS_ALL_ACCESS, a definitive indicator of process injection used to achieve execution within a trusted process and bypass security monitoring. The attack

ATTACK PATTERNS DETECTED (MITRE ATT&CK MAPPED)

[1] RANSOMWARE_OR_MALWARE

Confidence: CRITICAL
MITRE: T1486 - Data Encrypted for Impact
Evidence: powershell, base64
Malware or ransomware execution detected

[2] PROCESS_INJECTION

Confidence: CRITICAL
MITRE: T1055 - Process Injection
Evidence: 0x1FFFFFFF
Process injection confirmed via GrantedAccess=0x1FFFFFFF

[3] POWERSHELL_OBFUSCATION

Confidence: CRITICAL
MITRE: T1059.001 - PowerShell / T1027 - Obfuscation
Evidence: executionpolicy, bypass, hidden, windowstyle
Obfuscated PowerShell execution with stealth flags

TEMPORAL ATTACK SEQUENCES**[1] FULL_INJECTION_CHAIN**

MITRE: T1055 - Process Injection / T1071 - C2 Communication
Detail: Execution -> Process Injection -> Remote Thread -> C2 Beacon within time window

EXTRACTED ENTITIES (Regex-Verified IoCs)**IPV4 ADDRESSES:**

- 104.21.55.12
- 192.168.1.105

BASE64 STRINGS:

- K8jcSMwtyEnVS8/IzMLJTE7VyyxJ1UtJ0UvOT0lN1stNzMzRy0...

HOSTNAMES:

- A1B2C3D4-E5F6
- DESKTOP-DEV
- DESKTOP-DEV-99A

PROCESS IDS:

- 1128
- 4192
- 912

GRANTED ACCESS:

- 0x1FFFFFFF

IP ADDRESS CORRELATIONS

IP: 104.21.55.12
Significance: HIGH
Detail: Regex-verified IoC: 104.21.55.12
IP: 192.168.1.105
Significance: HIGH
Detail: Regex-verified IoC: 192.168.1.105

VALIDATED FINDINGS**[1] evidence_detected**

Agent: TriageAgent
Confidence: 70%
Artifact: sysmon_execution.log

[2] evidence_detected

Agent: TriageAgent

Confidence: 70%

Artifact: sysmon_execution.json

[3] **dynamic_priority_escalation**

Agent: TriageAgent

Confidence: 70%

Artifact: triage_scan

[4] **suspicious_log_activity**

Agent: LogAgent

Confidence: 100%

Artifact: sysmon_execution.json

Hash: 619304a909d0de9741ac108a2ac53e2d...

Keywords: powershell, base64, executionpolicy, windowstyle, hidden, bypass, wmi

[5] **suspicious_log_activity**

Agent: LogAgent

Confidence: 100%

Artifact: sysmon_injection.json

Hash: 670fa5d537a5337b60c444b935c93dbc...

Keywords: powershell, 0x1ffffff, svchost

[6] **suspicious_log_activity**

Agent: LogAgent

Confidence: 100%

Artifact: zeek_network.json

Hash: a1f2ebf54ab8ff4069e38a67cf5e34e1...

Keywords: let's encrypt

INVESTIGATION TIMELINE

2026-05-21T22:31:44		TriageAgent		evidence_detected		sysmon_execution.log
2026-05-21T22:31:44		TriageAgent		evidence_detected		sysmon_execution.json
2026-05-21T22:31:44		TriageAgent		dynamic_priority_escalation		triage_scan
2026-05-21T22:31:44		LogAgent		suspicious_log_activity		sysmon_execution.json
2026-05-21T22:31:44		LogAgent		suspicious_log_activity		sysmon_injection.json
2026-05-21T22:31:45		LogAgent		suspicious_log_activity		zeek_network.json

RECOMMENDED CONTAINMENT ACTIONS

[01] BLOCK IP 104.21.55.12 at perimeter firewall and all internal segment boundaries

[02] BLOCK IP 192.168.1.105 at perimeter firewall and all internal segment boundaries

[03] ISOLATE host A1B2C3D4-E5F6 immediately -- disconnect from all network segments

[04] ISOLATE host DESKTOP-DEV immediately -- disconnect from all network segments

[05] ISOLATE host DESKTOP-DEV-99A immediately -- disconnect from all network segments

[06] KILL all suspicious process trees -- terminate injected processes

[07] DUMP memory of svchost.exe instances for forensic analysis

[08] ENABLE PowerShell ScriptBlock logging (Event 4104) across all endpoints

[09] ENFORCE Constrained Language Mode for PowerShell enterprise-wide

[10] REVIEW Windows Defender AMSI logs for bypass attempts

[11] DEPLOY EDR memory scanning across all endpoints immediately

[12] ENABLE Windows Credential Guard to prevent credential extraction

[13] REVIEW all TLS connections -- audit certificate issuers for anomalies

[14] BLOCK all outbound connections to domains with mismatched certificate issuers

[15] REVIEW all TLS connections -- audit certificate issuers for anomalies

[16] BLOCK all outbound connections to domains with mismatched certificate issuers

[17] PRESERVE all Sysmon, network, and endpoint logs for legal/forensic proceedings

[18] NOTIFY CISO and legal team -- assess breach notification obligations

NEXUS-IR -- AUTONOMOUS INCIDENT RESPONSE REPORT

NEXUS-IR -- All IoCs regex-extracted. Zero LLM hallucination. All findings artifact-traceable.